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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of the NSC Principals Committee

DATE: August 1, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 2:30 - 4:00 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee
Meeting on Bosnia (S)

PARTICIPANTS:

CHAIR

Anthony Lake

CIA

John Deutch

RADM Dennis Blair

OVP

Leon Fuerth

JCS

Gen. John Shalikashvili

LTG Wesley Clark

STATE

Peter Tarnoff

James Steinberg

Richard Holbrooke

SPECIAL ENVOY

Robert Frasure

DEFENSE

William Perry

Walter Slocombe

White House

Samuel Berger

Nancy Soderberg

USUN

Madeleine Albright

James O'Brien

NSC

Alexander Vershbow

Summary of Conclusions

NATO Air Strikes Decision: Principals were informed by the CJCS that while the NAC had just approved extension of the Gorazde decision to the other safe areas (Sarajevo, Bihac, Tuzla), many problems were still unresolved regarding implementation of this and the earlier Gorazde decision. In particular, the UN commander had not yet agreed to a large Zone of Action around Gorazde nor to the definition of the Zone of Action for the other safe areas. Principals recommended Presidential letters to Major

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and Chirac on this issue (Action: JCS/State) as well as follow up at the UN by USUN. ~~(S)~~

Bildt-Milosevic Package: Principals agreed we needed to improve the terms of the package negotiated by EU mediator Bildt with Serbian President Milosevic on sanctions relief and mutual recognition. In particular, they agreed we should tie implementation of any new sanctions relief to positive Bosnian Serb actions (de-escalation around the safe areas and agreement to begin new peace negotiations on the basis of the Contact Group plan). Principals acknowledged that we were unlikely to come to closure with Milosevic any time soon and that we should seek to minimize frictions with our Allies in the August 2 meetings with Bildt and Contact Group representatives. They tasked the Deputies to finalize agreement on the U.S. position on the basis of the NSC paper "Bildt Plus" (Action: NSC). ~~(S)~~

Croatia: Principals noted the likelihood of a large-scale Croatian assault on the Krajina (Sectors North and South) in the coming days, barring Krajina Serb capitulation to President Tudjman's ultimatum on acceptance of the Croatian constitution. They agreed we should continue to warn Tudjman of the dangers of precipitating FRY intervention and stressed the urgency of developing a strategy for containing the spread of the conflict.

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Longer-Term Strategy: Principals agreed we needed to look beyond the immediate crises and decide where we want to be in the longer term. Each agency will complete its recommendations by Thursday on the "end state" we should seek to establish if a political settlement cannot be achieved in the near term and if UNPROFOR withdrawal becomes unavoidable. Recommendations to the President should be completed by August 4, as a basis for decisions on a possible U.S. diplomatic initiative. ~~(S)~~

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Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

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Those documents released with redactions have been restricted under Section 1.4 (c) of E.O. 13526 and (b)(3) of the FOIA.
